12-04 第1篇

阅读理解（记叙文） The First Saturday I Bought Vegetables Alone at the Market

① On the first Saturday of December, at 07:10 in the morning, my mother put a thin pink shopping list on the kitchen table and said, *"Yiran, the flu has finally caught me. Could you go to Xili Market alone today and buy these?"* She had written: **300 g Chinese cabbage · 2 tomatoes · 1 small cucumber · 250 g pork (shoulder cut) · 3 sticks of spring onion · 1 small piece of ginger · 1 bottle of soy sauce.** Next to the list, she had placed **one green banknote of 100 yuan**, folded once in the middle, and a small canvas bag. *"Keep the receipts,"* she said softly from the sofa, her voice hoarse, *"and don't be polite — **ask for the price twice** before you pay."* I was fourteen. I had been to the market a hundred times **with** her. I had never gone **alone**.

② Xili Market is a ten-minute walk from our building. On Saturdays it opens at seven and is, by half past, very alive. As I pushed open the heavy plastic door-curtain, the whole warm, wet, cold-bright world of a Chinese wet market came at me at once: **the smell of spring onions and fresh coriander**, **the sound of a knife hitting a wooden block**, the shining pile of tomatoes under a single yellow lamp, and a grandmother near the eggs calling to her friend two stalls away: *"Lǎo Sūn — still no cabbage? I told you, come early!"* My hands were cold. My canvas bag was empty. My list was slightly wrinkled from my pocket.

③ I decided, sensibly, to begin with the easiest item: **the Chinese cabbage**. The cabbage aunty, whose stall I have known since I was six, did not recognise me at first — probably because, without my mother, I looked smaller. I said, *"Three hundred grams, please."* She weighed it, pressed the tare button, and said, *"Two yuan one."* I was surprised. I had thought a cabbage would be more. I gave her a five-yuan note, received two coins and a one-yuan note, and put them carefully in the small paper envelope I had prepared at home. Her smile, when she finally saw my face under the hood, got a little larger. *"Your mother unwell?"* she asked, quietly. I nodded. *"Tell her to drink pear soup,"* she said.

④ At the vegetable row, I chose two tomatoes by the small rule my mother had taught me: **slightly soft to the fingers, deep red, tops green and fresh**. I picked a cucumber that was **straight and not too shiny**. I paid four yuan eighty for the three. The vegetable uncle chuckled, *"First time alone?"* I nodded. He added a small sprig of coriander to my bag and said, *"That is free. For the soup."* My ears felt warm for the first time that morning. **Kindness, I realised, grows on the edges of exchanges.**

⑤ The pork stall, however, was my real test. I had never bought pork alone. The butcher, whose right arm is the size of a small tree, was not scary at all — but the prices were a

long red list on the wall, and my mother's note had just said *"250 g pork (shoulder cut)"*. I waited my turn. Then I said, as clearly as I could, *"Please, 250 grams of shoulder cut."* He nodded, lifted a clean pink piece, trimmed it, weighed it: 251 grams exactly. *"Two yuan extra, okay?"* he asked. I nodded. Total: 13.80 yuan. I paid, watched the thin paper receipt slip into my bag, and, remembering my mother's soft voice from the sofa, I said, *"May I ask — is this the shoulder, definitely?"* He laughed — not unkindly. *"Definitely. Good girl to ask twice."* Another kindness. **Twice asked, once cooked, no regret.**

⑥ Spring onions: three sticks for one yuan. Ginger: a small knobby piece for 0.50. Soy sauce: a bottle of the one my mother always buys, 11.80 yuan. I did a small sum on the back of the list, in pencil, because my mother had asked me to check: *cabbage 2.10 + vegetables 4.80 + coriander 0 + pork 13.80 + onions 1.00 + ginger 0.50 + soy 11.80 = 34.00 yuan.* From 100, that should be **66 change**. I counted. The change was 66. I breathed out slowly. **I had never before noticed that arithmetic, done right, also produces a small quiet feeling in the chest**.

⑦ Walking home through the cold, sharp December light, my canvas bag was full and, honestly, heavier than I had expected. The spring onions stuck out of the top like green feathers. A small old man I did not know, passing me, smiled and said, *"Grandma sick?"* — mistaking my age kindly. *"Mother,"* I corrected. He nodded. *"Go home quickly then. Careful of the stairs."* I decided I liked this market morning more than any weekend I could remember. I noticed, too, that the street was full of people like me — people carrying small, honest bags — and that a city is really held together, quietly, by these morning walks.

⑧ At home, I laid everything on the kitchen table. My mother counted from the sofa: list — seven items. Table — seven items. She did not get up; she only said, *"The pork looks good."* I handed her the change — 66 yuan — and the receipts. She looked at each one carefully, not because she doubted me, but, I understood later, **because looking at the small paper receipts of a child's first solo trip is itself a small ceremony**. *"Thank you, Yiran,"* she said. I went to the kitchen, washed the cabbage, peeled the ginger, and, following Dad's kitchen rules from last month, **began to cook**: pork-and-cabbage noodle soup with a little coriander and a few drops of soy, the way my grandma taught my mother, and my mother taught me.

⑨ We ate on the sofa. The pork was, truly, tender; the soup was only a little too salty. My mother, smiling through her cough, said, *"Yiran, next Saturday?"* I thought. I said, *"Yes, Mom. Next Saturday too."* Later, cleaning the bowls, I thought about the sprig of coriander the vegetable uncle had added for free, and the butcher's *"good girl to ask twice"*, and the old man on the stairs, and the cabbage aunty's *"drink pear soup"*. **A market**, I understood, **is not just a place to buy vegetables. It is a place where a whole neighbourhood reminds a fourteen-year-old, through small acts, that she is part of something very old and very warm** — the long daily kitchen of a city.

⑩ That night, before bed, I wrote four lines:

Dec 4. Xili Market. Alone.
Cabbage, tomatoes, cucumber, pork, onions, ginger, soy. All bought. Change 66 yuan. Correct.
Kindness found: free coriander, butcher's smile, stranger's "careful of the stairs", aunty's pear-soup advice.
I think this was today's real lesson.

注释： coriander 香菜；butcher 肉贩；shoulder cut 前肩肉；receipt 收据；tare 去皮重

根据短文内容，选择最佳答案。

1. Why did the writer go to Xili Market alone on Saturday morning?

A. Because she wanted to play with friends.
B. Because her school required it.
C. Because her mother had been caught by the flu and asked her to buy a list of seven items (cabbage, tomatoes, cucumber, pork, spring onions, ginger, soy sauce), giving her a 100-yuan note and telling her to keep the receipts and to "ask for the price twice" before paying.
D. Because she wanted to earn pocket money.

2. What small kindness did the vegetable uncle add to her bag after she paid 4.80 yuan for tomatoes and a cucumber?

A. He gave her more tomatoes.
B. He gave her a free sprig of coriander, "for the soup", after teasing that it was her first time alone.
C. He returned all her money.
D. He gave her a candy.

3. What did the writer do at the pork stall that made the butcher say, "Good girl to ask twice"?

A. She bought twice the amount.
B. She paid twice.
C. She asked him, after the pork was weighed (251 g for 13.80 yuan), "Please — is this the shoulder, definitely?" — remembering her mother's soft advice to ask for the price / the cut twice before paying.
D. She ordered two different meats.

4. When the writer got home, how did her sick mother treat the receipts and change?

A. She threw them away without looking.
B. She ran to the kitchen to cook.
C. She looked at each receipt carefully — not because she doubted Yiran, but, as Yiran

later understood, because looking at the small paper receipts of a child's first solo trip is itself a small ceremony — and said "Thank you, Yiran."
D. She gave the change to the cat.

5. What did the writer mainly learn about the Xili Market in this morning?

A. That a market is just a place for buying food quickly.
B. That a market is not just a place to buy vegetables but a place where a whole neighbourhood — the aunty, the butcher, the uncle, a stranger on the stairs — reminds a fourteen-year-old, through small acts (free coriander, a gentle joke, a warning about the stairs, pear-soup advice), that she is part of something very old and very warm — the long daily kitchen of a city.
C. That the prices at the market are very expensive.
D. That she should not go to the market alone again.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第①段缘起
【解析】"感冒 / 清单 / 100 元 / 问两次"直引。A、B、D 均错。故选 C。

2.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第④段"free coriander"
【解析】"添了一把香菜"直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

3.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑤段肉摊问答
【解析】"definitely 是肩肉"直引。A、B、D 均错。故选 C。

4.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑧段
【解析】"仪式 + 谢谢"直引。A、B、D 均错。故选 C。

5.
【答案】B
【题型】主旨大意题

【定位】第⑨段总结
【解析】"城市的长厨房"主旨。A、C、D 均偏离。故选 B。